

HEEJUN KIM

 [Homepage](#)  [Email](#)  [GitHub](#)  [Google Scholar](#)

EDUCATION

- Korea Advanced Institute of Science and Technology (KAIST)** *September 2026 - present*
M.S. in Artificial Intelligence, Supervised by [Prof. Sehoon Kim](#)
- Gwangju Institute of Science and Technology (GIST)** *February 2020 - August 2026*
B.S. in Electrical Engineering and Computer Science
GPA: 4.2/4.5 (magna cum laude)
- University of California, Berkeley (UC Berkeley)** *June 2024 - August 2024*
Summer Session, GPA 4.0/4.0
Coursework: Introduction to Artificial Intelligence, Principles & Techniques of Data Science

RESEARCH EXPERIMENTS

- Learning and Adaptation Algorithm Lab** *January 2026 - August 2026*
Seoul National University, Advisor: [Prof. Taesup Kim](#) *Seoul, South Korea*
 - Conducting research on Agentic Memory Using LLM Uncertainty Estimation
 - Studied internal behavioral mechanisms of LLMs underlying reasoning, hallucination, and memory recall
- Data Science Lab** *Feb 2025 - August 2026, January 2024 - June 2024*
Gwangju Institute of Science and Technology, Advisor: [Prof. Sundong Kim](#) *Gwangju, South Korea*
 - Researched test-time adaptation with reinforcement learning for self-improving reasoning capabilities of large language models on the Abstract Reasoning Corpus (ARC)
 - Investigated metacognition-driven strategies for helping large language models escape local minima in reasoning
- Forschungszentrum Jülich** *September 2024 - February 2025*
Korea-Germany Junior Research Fellowship Program 2024 *Jülich, Germany*
 - Host Institute: INM-7 directed by [Prof. Simon B. Eickhoff](#) and contributed to Mathematical Neuroscience Group led by [Dr. Oleksandr Popovych](#).
 - Developed preprocessing pipeline for multi-modal MRI human connectome data using HPC and HyperThreading (Project Supervisor: [Dr. Kyesam Jung](#))
 - Fund: 12,000,000KRW (8,197EUR) by National Research Foundation of Korea (NRF)(No. RS-2023-00254343).

PUBLICATIONS

- From Noise to Diversity: Random Embedding Injection in LLM Reasoning**
[Heejun Kim](#), [Seungpil Lee](#), [Jewon Yeom](#), [Jaewon Sok](#), [Seonghyeon Park](#), [Jeongjae Park](#), [Taesup Kim](#), [Sundong Kim](#)
[Under Review] *ICML 2026 Mechanistic Interpretability Workshop (Spotlight, 2.8% acceptance rate)*. [\[Paper\]](#)
- Hallucination as Commitment Failure: Larger LLMs Misfire Despite Knowing the Answer**
[Jewon Yeom](#), [Jaewon Sok](#), [Heejun Kim](#), [Seonghyeon Park](#), [Jeongjae Park](#), [Taesup Kim](#)
[Under Review] *ICML 2026 Mechanistic Interpretability Workshop (Poster)*. [\[Paper\]](#)
- On the Role of Proposal Support in Diffusion-Based Offline RL for Sequential Decision-Making**
[Yunho Kim](#), [Jaehyun Park](#), [Heejun Kim](#), [Sejin Kim](#), [Byung-Jun Lee](#), [Sundong Kim](#)
[Under Review] *ICML 2026 DEMO Workshop (Poster)*. [\[Paper\]](#)
- Disentangling Question, Response, and Verifier Languages in Multilingual LLM Evaluation**
[Jewon Yeom](#), [Jaewon Sok](#), [Seonghyeon Park](#), [Heejun Kim](#), [Jeongjae Park](#), [Taesup Kim](#)
[Under Review]
- On the Tip of the Tongue: First-Token Cueing as a Behavioral Probe of Recall in LLMs**
[Jaewon Sok](#), [Jewon Yeom](#), [Heejun Kim](#), [Seonghyeon Park](#), [Jeongjae Park](#), [Taesup Kim](#)
[Under Review]

Efficient Epistemic Uncertainty Estimation for Large Language Models via Knowledge Distillation

Seonghyeon Park, Jewon Yeom, Jaewon Sok, Jeongjae Park, Heejun Kim, Taesup Kim

[Under Review] [[Paper](#)]

PROJECTS

Skill-based Reinforcement Learning with UCB Skill Selection

May 2025 - June 2025

- Reproduced BeCL framework for unsupervised skill discovery in reinforcement learning environments
- Developed Multi-Armed Bandit approach with UCB algorithm to improve downstream task adaptation efficiency. [[Poster](#)]

Hyundai AI Challenge

September 2023 - October 2023

- Processed large-scale port logistics datasets (cleaning, feature extraction, temporal aggregation).
- Built tree-based boosting models to predict ship waiting times.
- Ranked Top 25/330 teams among 1,300+ participants.

LEADERSHIPS

Teaching Assistant

Fall 2025

- Machine Learning & Deep Learning (AI5213/EC4213): led TA sessions, held office hours, managed assignments/exams, and organized Kaggle competition. [[Homepage](#)]

Korea Army Instructor

February 2021 - August 2022

- Served as an Army instructor in the 50th Division in Daegu, South Korea
- Conducted basic training for approximately 2000 military personnel

EXTRA ACTIVITIES

Google Developer Student Club

September 2023 - February 2024

- Participated in an AI study focused on machine learning and deep learning
- Studied models in ML/DL and analysis of top team models in Kaggle AI competitions
- Established study directions and organized study materials as a team leader

Financial Investment Conference

March 2023 - March 2024

- Conducted a study on economics
- Analyzed and presented economic markets on a weekly basis

GIST Club Federation

February 2020 - December 2020

- Managed clubs in Gwangju Institute of Science and Technology

SKILLS

Programming Languages

Python, C/C++

Python Packages & Framework

PyTorch, VeRL, Scikit-learn, Pandas, Numpy, Matplotlib, Ray

Operating System

Linux, Windows, MacOS

Others

Docker, Wandb, SLURM, HTCondor, SQLite

HONORS

Government Scholarship, Gwangju Institute of Science and Technology

2020 - August 2026

Government Scholarship, STEM scholarship

2020 - August 2026

Dean's List, College of Information and Computing, GIST

Spring 2025, Fall 2025

GIST International Internship Support Program

September 2024 - February 2025

Korea-Germany Junior Research Fellowship Program 2024

September 2024 - February 2025

- Organized by the Max Planck POSTECH/KOREA Research (MPK)